

What I am about to say, I say it with absolute love.

If your parents were never financially successful, stop taking financial advice from them.

I know that's hard to hear but it might be the most important shift you make this year.

Love and financial competence are not the same thing.

Your parents can be incredible people, hardworking, loving, full of wisdom about life, relationships, and character and still have zero blueprint for building wealth.

I had to unlearn this.

The truth is.... you can't teach what you never learned.

If your parents spent their whole lives living paycheck to paycheck, avoiding investing because it felt "risky," or believing debt was just a normal part of life, that's not a personal failure on their part. That's just the information they had. But it's not information that will move you forward.

Think about what you currently know about wealth.

"Save every penny" from someone who never invested.

"Don't take risks" from someone who never took one that paid off.

"A good job is enough" from someone who worked one job for 30 years and retired with nothing extra

"Rich people are lucky/greedy/different from us" from someone who never got close enough to find out

None of that is malicious, but all of it is limiting.

If you are aiming for serious financial freedom, do this instead:

Separate the person from the advice.

You can love your parents and still say "their financial playbook isn't mine."

Find mentors who are living the outcome you want.

Please I am not referring to people who talk about wanting it, people who have it, or are visibly building toward it.

Get comfortable being the first.

If you're breaking a cycle, there's no map. You're going to feel behind, confused, and uncertain. That's not a sign you're doing it wrong. That's what "first" feels like.

Study people, not just content.

Read the books, follow the people, learn from the mentors who actually built wealth not just people who are good at talking about it.

At the end of the day, no one is blaming anyone.

Your parents did the best they could with what they knew.

But you don't have to inherit their financial ceiling.

You get to build your own.